

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

----- X
BRUCE MCCOY,

Plaintiff,

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NYPD POLICE OFFICER
BENJAMIN HINDERMAN, Shield No. 3689, NYPD
POLICE OFFICER EDGAR GUERRERO, Shield No.
5447, NYPD POLICE OFFICERS JOHN and JANE DOES
NUMBERS ONE THROUGH TEN,

Defendants.
----- X

SUMMONS

Index No.:

The Basis of Venue is:
Location of Incident

Plaintiff designates Bronx
County as the place of trial.

To the above named Defendants:

You are hereby summoned to answer the Verified Complaint in this action, and to serve a copy of your Verified Answer to the Verified Complaint, or, if the Verified Complaint is not served with this Summons, to serve a notice of appearance on the Plaintiff's attorneys within twenty days after the service of this Summons, exclusive of the day of service, where service is made by delivery upon you personally within the state, or, within 30 days after completion of service where service is made in any other manner. In case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

DATED: New York, New York
March 17, 2022

Yours, etc.

David R. Kline

David R. Kline, Esq.

Shulman-Hill, PLLC

Attorneys for Plaintiff

1 State Street Plaza, 15th Floor

New York, New York 10004

(212) 221-1000

TO: THE CITY OF NEW YORK, Corporation Counsel, 100 Church Street, NY, NY 10007
POLICE OFFICER BENJAMIN HINDERMAN, 84th NYPD PRECINCT, 300 Gold
Street, Brooklyn, NY 11201
POLICE OFFICER EDGAR GUERRERO, 43rd NYPD PRECINCT, 900 Fteley Ave,
Bronx, NY 10473

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

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INDEX NO.:

VERIFIED COMPLAINT

JURY TRIAL DEMANDED

Plaintiff BRUCE MCCOY, by his attorneys, Shulman-Hill, PLLC, as and for his Verified Complaint herein, alleges upon information and belief as follows:

PRELIMINARY STATEMENT

1. This is a civil rights action to recover money damages arising out of defendants' violation of Plaintiff's rights as secured by the Civil Rights Act, 42 U.S.C. Sections 1983 and 1988, and of rights secured by the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, and the common law and the laws of the State of New York. On December 26, 2020, at approximately 3:00 p.m., Plaintiff Bruce McCoy, while lawfully in the vicinity of 1333 Webster Avenue, County of Bronx, New York, was subject to an unlawful arrest, detention, assault, battery and excessive use of force by Defendant Police Officers. Plaintiff was deprived of his constitutional, common law and statutory rights when the individual defendants unlawfully stopped, detained, assaulted, battered, subjected to excessive force, passed along false accusations to prosecuting attorneys and engaged in the malicious prosecution of Plaintiff, in violation of the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, the common law and the laws of the State of New York.

PARTIES

2. Plaintiff BRUCE MCCOY is a resident of the state of New York.

3. NYPD Police Officer Benjamin Hinderman, Shield No. 3689, is and was at all times relevant herein an Officer with the New York City Police Department.

4. At all times relevant herein, NYPD Police Officer Benjamin Hinderman, Shield No. 3689, was assigned to the 44th Police Precinct of the NYPD. Officer Hinderman is currently assigned to the 84th NYPD Precinct.

5. NYPD Police Officer Benjamin Hinderman, Shield No. 3689, is being sued in their individual and official capacity.

6. NYPD Police Officer Edgar Guerrero, Shield No. 5447, is and was at all times relevant herein an Officer with the New York City Police Department.

7. Currently and at all times relevant herein, NYPD Police Officer Edgar Guerrero, Shield No. 5447, was assigned to the 43rd Police Precinct of the NYPD.

8. NYPD Police Officer Edgar Guerrero, Shield No. 5447, is being sued in their individual and official capacity.

9. NYPD Police Officers John and Jane Does Numbers One through Ten are and were at all times relevant herein officers, employees, and agents of the New York City Police Department.

10. NYPD Police Officers John and Jane Does Numbers One through Ten are being sued in their individual and official capacities.

11. At all times relevant herein, the individual defendants were acting under color of state law in the course and scope of their duties and functions as agents, servants, employees and officers of the New York City Police Department, and otherwise performed and engaged in conduct incidental to the performance of their lawful functions in the course of their duties. They were acting for and on behalf of the New York City Police Department at all times relevant herein, with the power and authority vested in them as officers, agents and employees of the New York City Police Department and incidental to the lawful pursuit of their duties as officers, employees and agents of the New York City Police Department.

12. Defendant City of New York is a municipal entity created and authorized under the laws of the State of New York. It is authorized by law to maintain a police department, which acts as its agent in the area of law enforcement and for which it is ultimately responsible. The defendant City of New York assumes the risks incidental to the maintenance of a police force and the employment of police officers as said risks attach to the public consumers of the services provided by the New York City Police Department.

13. Plaintiff in furtherance of his causes of action brought pursuant to New York State law filed a timely Notice of Claim against the City of New York in compliance with the Municipal Law Section 50 and in accordance with New York State law on March 24, 2021.

14. This action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602, involving intentional actions, as well as the defendant, and/or defendants, having acted in reckless disregard for the safety of others, as well as having performed intentional acts.

15. Plaintiff has sustained damages in an amount in excess of the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts of the State of New York.

STATEMENT OF FACTS

16. On December 26, 2020, at approximately 3:00 p.m., Plaintiff was present in the vicinity of 1333 Webster Avenue, County of Bronx, New York, when the defendant officers unlawfully, detained, arrested, searched, and assaulted Plaintiff without legal justification.

17. Plaintiff was sitting in a legally parked vehicle, with the engine off.

18. Plaintiff, without warning or reason, was suddenly grabbed by multiple Defendant officers.

19. Plaintiff was ripped out of the vehicle he was in and placed in handcuffs by Defendant officers.

20. Despite Plaintiff's pleas for information, none of his assailants told him why he was being arrested or where he was being taken.

21. In the course of ambushing Plaintiff and roughly throwing him into a vehicle, Defendant officers repeatedly punched Plaintiff in and about his face and neck.

22. Plaintiff remained at the 44th NYPD Precinct for hours before being transported to Central Bookings.

23. Plaintiff repeatedly requested medical attention, but those requests were denied by Defendant officers.

24. While Plaintiff was in custody, the defendant police officers provided the Bronx County District Attorney's Office with the false, misleading and/or incomplete information that Plaintiff committed a crime.

25. Client was taken in custody by Defendant NYPD Officers to central booking.

26. At arraignment, Plaintiff bail was set in the amount of \$100,000.

27. After arraignment, Plaintiff was detained on Rikers Island for a period of six (6) days, after which time he was released pursuant to NY C.P.L. § 180.80.

28. Plaintiff's criminal case was dismissed and sealed on May 5, 2021.

29. At no time relevant herein did Plaintiff commit a crime or violate the law in any way, nor did the police officers have an objective reason to accuse Plaintiff of committing a crime or violating the law in any way.

30. At no point did Defendant Officers recover any drugs, weapons, or other illegal contraband from Plaintiff or from a location that was in Plaintiff's possession, custody, or control.

31. Nevertheless, Plaintiff was unlawfully arrested and handcuffed by defendant officers without legal justification or probable cause, unlawfully fingerprinted, photographed and searched, and unlawfully detained.

32. Some defendant officers observed the violation of Plaintiff's rights under the Constitution of the United States and New York State Law and did nothing to prevent their fellow officers from unjustifiably assaulting, battering, and using excessive force against Plaintiff.

33. The unlawful assault, battery, and use of excessive force by the individually named Defendant NYPD Officers caused Plaintiff to sustain physical, psychological and emotional trauma.

FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION
Unlawful Stop, Question, and Search

34. The Plaintiff repeats and realleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

35. The illegal approach, pursuit, stop and grab employed by defendants herein terminated Plaintiff's freedom of movement through means intentionally applied.

36. The conduct of defendants in approaching, stopping, and grabbing Plaintiff was performed under color of law and without any reasonable suspicion of criminality or other constitutionally required grounds.

37. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

38. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

39. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION
Violation of Fourth and Fourteenth Amendment Rights:
Unlawful Seizure and Deprivation of Liberty

40. The Plaintiff repeats and realleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

41. The individually named police officer defendants, while acting in concert and within the scope of their authority, caused Plaintiff to be seized, unlawfully searched, falsely arrested, and falsely imprisoned, and maliciously prosecuted without reasonable suspicion and/or probable cause, in violation of Plaintiff's right to be free of an unreasonable seizure under the Fourth Amendment of the Constitution of the United States and to be free of a deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States.

42. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, emotional and psychological injuries.

THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION

False Imprisonment

43. The Plaintiff repeats and realleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

44. The acts and conduct of the defendants constitute false arrest and false imprisonment under the laws of the State of New York. Defendants intended to confine Plaintiff and, in fact, confined Plaintiff, and Plaintiff was conscious of the confinement. In addition, Plaintiff did not consent to the confinement and the confinement was not otherwise privileged.

45. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York and the United States Constitution.

46. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

47. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of respondeat superior.

48. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to loss of liberty, emotional and psychological injuries.

FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Violation of Plaintiff's Fourth And Fourteenth Amendment Rights: Excessive Force

49. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

50. The use of excessive force by defendants by, amongst other things, roughly handcuffing, grabbing and throwing Plaintiff into a vehicle and punching and hitting him during the course of the arrest constituted objectively unreasonable physical seizures of Plaintiff in

violation of his rights under the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the Constitution of the United States and to be free of a deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States.

51. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of his employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Assault

52. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

53. Defendants, their agents, servants and employees, acting within the scope of their employment, intentionally, willfully and maliciously assaulted Plaintiff in that they had the real or apparent ability to cause imminent harmful and/or offensive bodily contact and intentionally did a violent and/or menacing act which threatened such contact to the Plaintiff, that such acts caused apprehension of such contact in the Plaintiff.

54. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

55. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

56. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

57. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Battery

58. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

59. Defendants, their agents, servants and employees, acting within the scope of their employment, intentionally, willfully and maliciously battered Plaintiff, when they, in a hostile and/or offensive manner, roughly handcuffed, grabbed and threw Plaintiff into a vehicle and punched and hit Plaintiff while brutally effecting an arrest of Plaintiff without his consent and with

the intention of causing harmful and/or offensive bodily contact to the Plaintiff and caused such battery.

60. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

61. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

62. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

63. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION
Negligent Infliction of Emotional Distress

64. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

65. By the actions described herein, defendants, each acting individually and in concert with each other, engaged in extreme and outrageous conduct, conduct utterly intolerable in a civilized community, which negligently caused severe emotional distress to Plaintiff. The acts and conduct of the defendants were the direct and proximate cause of injury and damage to Plaintiff and violated Plaintiff's statutory and common law rights as guaranteed by the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

66. The acts and conduct of the defendants were the direct and proximate cause of injury and damage to Plaintiff and violated Plaintiff's statutory and common law rights as guaranteed Plaintiff by the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

67. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

68. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

69. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

70. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

EIGHTH CAUSE OF ACTION**Negligent Hiring, Retention, Training and Supervision**

71. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

72. The City of New York and its employees, servants and/or agents acting within the scope of their employment did negligently hire, retain, train and supervise defendants, individuals who were unfit for the performance of police duties on the aforementioned dates at the aforementioned locations.

73. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, emotional and psychological injuries.

TENTH CAUSE OF ACTION**Failure to Intervene**

74. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

75. The defendants that did not physically touch Plaintiff, but were present when other officers violated Plaintiff's Constitutional Rights had an affirmative duty to intervene on behalf of Plaintiff, whose constitutional rights were being violated in their presence by other officers.

76. Defendants failed to intervene to prevent the unlawful conduct described herein.

77. As a result of the foregoing, Plaintiff's suffered significant injury, his liberty was restricted for an extended period of time, he was put in fear of his safety, he did not receive necessary medical treatment, and he was humiliated and subject to other physical constraints.

78. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

79. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

80. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

81. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

ELEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Violation of Fourth And Fourteenth Amendment Rights:

Denial of Right to Fair Trial/Due Process

82. The Plaintiff repeats and realleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

83. Defendants, individually and collectively, manufactured and/or withheld false evidence and forwarded this false evidence to prosecutors in the Bronx County District Attorney's Office.

84. Defendants filled out false and misleading police reports and forwarded them to prosecutors in the Bronx County District Attorney's Office.

85. Defendants signed false and misleading criminal court affidavits and forwarded them to prosecutors in the Bronx County District Attorney's Office.

86. In withholding/creating false evidence against Plaintiff, and in providing/withholding information with respect thereto, Defendants violated Plaintiff's constitutional right to due process and fair trial under the New York State Constitution and under the Due Process Clause of the Fifth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States and to be free to deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the United States Constitution.

87. As a result of the foregoing, Plaintiff sustained, inter alia, loss of the right to due process and a fair trial, loss of liberty, emotional distress, embarrassment and humiliation, and deprivation of his constitutional rights.

88. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

89. The City, as the employer of the officer Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of respondeat superior.

90. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of Defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries including, but not limited to: economic, emotional and psychological injuries.

TWELFTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Malicious Prosecution

91. The Plaintiff repeats and realleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

92. The acts and conduct of the Defendants constitute malicious prosecution under the United States Constitution.

93. Defendants commenced and continued a criminal proceeding against Plaintiff.

94. There was actual malice and an absence of probable cause for the criminal proceeding against Plaintiff and for each of the charges for which they were prosecuted.

95. The prosecution and criminal proceedings terminated in Plaintiff's favor on the aforementioned dates.

THIRTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION
Deliberate Indifference to Medical Needs

96. The Plaintiff repeats and realleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

97. Defendants despite being aware that Plaintiff was suffering from injuries stemming from their brutal beating during arrest, and therefore requiring and requesting additional treatment from medical professionals, delayed Plaintiff's medical treatment and refused to administer and properly procure immediate and adequate medical attention.

98. The delay in medical treatment to Plaintiff's injuries resulted in increased severity in Plaintiff's injuries that would have been prevented if Plaintiff received treatment in a timely manner.

99. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

100. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

101. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of respondeat superior.

102. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

FOURTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION
Violation of Article I, § 12 of the New York State Constitution

103. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges each and every allegation contained in the above paragraphs with the same force and effect as if fully set forth herein.

104. Such conduct breached the protections guaranteed to plaintiff by the New York State Constitution, including but not limited to, Article 1, §§ 1, 6, 8, 9, 11, and 12, and including the following rights:

- i. freedom from unreasonable search and seizure of her person and property;
- ii. freedom from arrest without probable cause;
- iii. freedom from false imprisonment, that being wrongfully detained without good faith, reasonable suspicion, or legal justification, and of which wrongful detention plaintiff was aware and did not consent;
- iv. freedom from the lodging of false charges against him by police officers and prosecutors, including on information and belief, by some or all of the individual defendants; and
- v. freedom from deprivation of liberty without due process of law.

105. As a direct and proximate result of defendants' deprivations of Plaintiff's rights, privileges, and immunities guaranteed by the New York State Constitution, Plaintiff suffered physical, economic and emotional injuries, as well as a deprivation of liberty.

106. As a result of the above tortious conduct, Plaintiff was caused to suffer physical, economic, and emotional injuries, as well as a deprivation of liberty.

107. As a result of the above unconstitutional conduct, the City of New York is liable for the conduct of the Individual Defendants and any damages they caused under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

JURY DEMAND

108. Plaintiff hereby demands trial by jury of all issues properly triable thereby.

PRAYER FOR RELIEF

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff BRUCE MCCOY demands judgment against the defendants on each cause of action in amounts to be determined upon the trial of this action which exceeds the jurisdiction of lower courts, inclusive of punitive damages and attorneys' fees inclusive of costs and disbursements of this action, interest and such other relief as is appropriate under the law, and that the Plaintiff recover the cost of the suit herein, including reasonable attorney's fees pursuant to 42 U.S.C. § 1988.

Dated: New York, New York
March 17, 2022

By: David R. Kline
David R. Kline, Esq.
Shulman-Hill, PLLC

Attorneys for Plaintiff
1 State Street Plaza
15th Floor
New York, New York 10004
(212) 221-1000

TO: THE CITY OF NEW YORK, Corporation Counsel, 100 Church Street, NY, NY 10007
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Street, Brooklyn, NY 11201
DETECTIVE EDGAR GUERRERO, 43rd NYPD PRECINCT, 900 Fteley Ave, Bronx, NY
10473

ATTORNEY'S VERIFICATION

DAVID R. KLINE, an attorney duly admitted to practice before the Courts of the State of New York, affirms the following to be true under the penalties of perjury:

I am a partner of the law firm of **SHULMAN-HILL PLLC**, I have read the annexed **VERIFIED COMPLAINT** and know the contents thereof, and the same are true to my knowledge, except those matters therein which are stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and as to those matters I believe them to be true. My belief, as to those matters therein not stated upon knowledge, is based upon facts, records, and other pertinent information contained in my files. The reason this verification is made by me and not Plaintiff is because Plaintiff does not reside in the county wherein I maintain my office.

DATED: New York, New York
March 17, 2022

David R. Kline
DAVID R. KLINE